

has been established over centuries of experience and should only be altered in extraordinary circumstances.

By way of illustration, consider this tableau from the L^AT_EX manual (p. 64 old edition):

gnats	gram	\$13.65
	each	.01
gnu	stuffed	92.50
emu		33.33
armadillo	frozen	8.99

This is a hotch-potch of information that is probably reasonably clearly presented as is (but is the emu stuffed or not?). However, as a published table, this should much rather appear along the lines suggested further down the page in the manual:

Item		
Animal	Description	Price (\$)
Gnat	per gram	13.65
	each	0.01
Gnu	stuffed	92.50
Emu	stuffed	33.33
Armadillo	frozen	8.99

It takes much less work to lay this out, as a formal table; we don't have to work out a new layout for everything we do. Moreover, we can be almost certain that the data cannot be misread, because the reader does not have to learn how to read some novel presentation.

The above table cannot be produced in pure L^AT_EX, unfortunately. It can be laid out as it should be, but despite your best efforts, using plain `\hline` commands produces

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Gnu	stuffed	92.50
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Note (if it is not already obvious) that there is not enough space between the top line and the capital I of 'Item', and so on for all the lines: contrast with the previous version. Also, in the first version the top and bottom rules (ie lines) are heavier than the middle rule, which is turn heavier than the subrule underneath 'Item'. Of course you *could* redefine `\doublerulesep` and then use `\hline\hline` to get something near the same effect, and you could use struts to improve the